Skill – Medicine (Wisdom) · SRD 5.2.1

Medicine is used to **heal and diagnose**: stabilize a dying creature, recognize a disease, find a cause of death. It uses a **Wisdom (Medicine)** check, often via the **Search** or **Utilize** action (healer's kit).

🎲 Quick summary:

1. **Wisdom (Medicine)** check.
2. Stabilize a dying creature: **DC 10**.
3. Recognize a disease or cause of death.
4. Doesn't restore HP: it stabilizes.

⚠ Change from 2014

SRD 2024 keeps stabilizing a creature at 0 HP with a Medicine DC 10 check.

⚠ Flaw in the rule and fixes Table rule

The SRD doesn't say what a healer's kit brings. Fix: it allows the check without Disadvantage.

💡 Narrative option: Table rule

The DM can describe the wound or symptoms to guide the diagnosis.

Step 1 – Identify the need:

Stabilize, diagnose, find a cause.

Step 2 – Use:

Utilize action to stabilize; Search to diagnose.

Step 3 – Set the DC:

DC 10 to stabilize; DC 15 for a subtle diagnosis.

Step 4 – Roll:

1d20 + Wisdom + proficiency.

Step 5 – Apply:

Success: creature stabilized (0 HP but no more death saves).

Example: Elora stabilizes Brann at 0 HP: Medicine 14 against DC 10. He's stabilized.

⚠ Common questions:

Does it restore HP?

No: it stabilizes.

What DC?

10 to stabilize.

Do I need a kit?

A healer's kit helps; without, Disadvantage possible.

Does it cure disease?

It recognizes it; curing needs a spell or rest.

Skill or spell?

A healing spell restores HP; Medicine doesn't.

Can I retry?

Only if the situation changes.

⚠ Debate points and table options: Table rule

Stabilizing without proficiency

Without proficiency: **Option**: DC 10 still applies.

Empty kit

Without a kit: **Option**: Disadvantage.

Disease

Curing through play. **Option**: high DC.

⚠ Rule clarifications (answers found on the web, reworded):

Stabilization

A stabilized creature stays at 0 HP but stops making death saves.

Action

Stabilizing uses the Utilize action.

No HP

Medicine doesn't restore hit points.

These points remain open to discussion: your feedback is welcome to refine this sheet.

Notices: This work includes material from the System Reference Document 5.2.1 ("SRD 5.2.1") by Wizards of the Coast LLC, available at https://www.dndbeyond.com/srd. The SRD 5.2.1 is licensed under the Creative Commons Attribution 4.0 International License, available at https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by/4.0/legalcode. Unofficial sheet, 5E compatible (2024 rules), neither approved nor sponsored by Wizards of the Coast. Rules come from SRD 5.2.1; where the SRD gives no answer, explanations rely on our own interpretation. The "Table rule" parts are the author's own creations. Borders, banner, texture, titles, layout, table rules and examples: © Jaja, all rights reserved. Sources: SRD 5.2.1 (official English version); rule clarifications cross-checked with answers found on the web and reworded; numeric examples are invented; last revised: November 2026. Fonts: TeX Gyre Pagella (GUST), DejaVu Sans, Noto Color Emoji (OFL).